



◁ PALACE AND MONUMENT

The vast honey-colored Schönbrunn Palace is overlooked by the Neo-Classical Gloriette monument on the crest of a hill in the park behind it.



Schönbrunn Palace

The sumptuous summer residence of the Habsburg rulers of the Austrian Empire

In the 1740s, work began on transforming a hunting lodge on the outskirts of Vienna into a summer palace for the Habsburg Austrian Empress Maria Theresa. The Habsburgs had the habit of building on a monumental scale, and Schönbrunn was no exception. Developed from an original design by architect Johann Fischer von Erlach, the vast Baroque palace eventually boasted a total of 1,441 finely decorated rooms, from vast reception and banqueting halls to the residential suites of members of the imperial family. The building sits in extensive gardens and landscaped parkland. The grounds include a menagerie, a palm house, an orangerie, a folly imitating Roman ruins, and the much-admired Gloriette—a Neo-Classical monument on the crest of the hill behind the palace, built to the design of architect Johann Hetzendorf von Hohenberg in 1775.

A rich history

Schönbrunn Palace is a site full of historical resonance. As a child prodigy, Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart performed there for Empress Maria Theresa at the age of 6. In the second half of the 19th century, it became the favorite palace of the much-loved Empress Elizabeth, who was tragically assassinated by an anarchist in 1898, and finally it was the site of the abdication of Austria's last emperor, Karl I, in 1918. Restored to their full imperial splendor after damage in World War II, the palace and gardens are now one of Vienna's major tourist attractions. The gardens extend from the palace and reflect the Baroque ideal that architecture and nature should be intertwined. With their highly ordered beds, the gardens were as much a symbol of Habsburg power as the house itself.



△ SURVIVING DESTRUCTION

The magnificent Imperial Hall, or *Kaisersaal*, is decorated with paintings by Giovanni Battista Tiepolo and his son Giovanni Domenico. It survived the bombing of Würzburg in 1945.

◁ COURT GARDENS

An aerial view shows the Würzburg Residence and the formal East Garden, created by Bavarian garden designer Johann Procop Mayer.